in war and peace, and then to see if the training was structured to meet that requirement. Each training establishment runs a number of courses, depending on its role. The Infantry School, for example, runs courses for officers, JCOs and jawans, and for differing levels of seniority even within this categorization. The Army War College, on the other hand, runs courses only for officers—the JC, SC and HC courses. Sometimes, the training establishments lost sight of the objective of a particular course being run by them. Over the years, new topics get added, and with each addition, the schedule gets tighter, with the result that students don't get adequate time for either preparation or assimilation. This was one of the aspects that I would particularly look into and deconflict the syllabus where possible. The purpose of any course was not to make a soldier a superhero but a competent and capable member of the team. During one of my visits to the Infantry School, in my address to the officers, one of them raised a point that the YO Course should not be graded, as a Young Officer getting a 'C' grading would get demotivated right at the beginning of his career. There was a hush in the hall when I revealed that I, too, had got a 'C' in the YOs, but there I was, right at the top, highlighting that it is sustained hard work and dedication that matters.

Of all the places, I ended up visiting Mhow the most, as it had three of the most prestigious establishments, the Infantry School, the MCTE and the Army War College, each commanded by a Lt Gen. To get to Mhow, it was first by air to Indore via Delhi and then by helicopter to Mhow. For this, the IAF helicopter would come from Gwalior or any other AF station, flying for maybe two hours for the fifteen-minute flight from Indore to Mhow, a forty-five-minute road trip. This I thought was quite superfluous and wasteful and started doing the Indore to Mhow leg by road. Veena was very happy

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